08-26 第一篇

The Butterfly Effect and Our Environment

The "butterfly effect" is the idea that a small change in one place can lead to much larger consequences elsewhere. The name comes from a famous question: Could the flapping of a butterfly's wings in Brazil eventually cause a tornado in Texas? In nature, tiny actions are often connected to big outcomes. [1] This concept helps us understand that our everyday choices can have far-reaching effects on the environment. What we do locally may influence the planet globally.

Pollution is a clear example. When factories release waste into rivers, the damage spreads downstream. Fish die, water becomes undrinkable, and communities suffer. [2] A single source of pollution can harm ecosystems miles away and affect countless species. Similarly, plastic thrown on a beach may be carried by currents to the ocean, where it threatens marine life. Small acts of carelessness add up to serious environmental problems.

Climate change also shows how connected our world is. Cars, factories, and power plants in one country emit greenhouse gases that warm the entire atmosphere. [3] Emissions from one region contribute to melting ice, rising seas, and extreme weather events everywhere. No nation is truly isolated from the effects of climate change. This interconnectedness means that both the problem and the solutions require global cooperation.

The good news is that the butterfly effect works both ways. [4] Small positive actions can also create large benefits. Recycling one bottle, planting one tree, or walking instead of driving short distances—each choice matters. When millions of people make these choices, the collective impact is enormous. Individual actions, combined with community efforts, can drive real change.

[5] Understanding the butterfly effect reminds us that we are not powerless. Every choice we make—what we buy, how we travel, how we waste or conserve—sends a ripple through the world. By making conscious, environmentally friendly decisions, we can be part of positive change. The butterfly's wings remind us that we all have a role to play in protecting our planet.

选项

A. This idea shows that our individual choices can have wide-ranging environmental impacts. B. One polluting source can damage ecosystems far beyond its immediate surroundings. C. Pollution and emissions from one area affect the whole planet and require global action. D. Simple positive actions, when done by many, can lead to

significant environmental improvement. E. Recognizing our power to influence change motivates us to make better choices for the Earth. F. For example, a single oil spill can kill thousands of birds and contaminate miles of coastline.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前解释蝴蝶效应概念及自然中微小行动与重大结果的关系；空后强调“我们在当地所做的事可能在全球范围内产生影响”。A项“这一概念帮助我们理解日常选择可能对环境产生深远影响”承上承接概念，启下引出个人选择的全球性，起承上启下作用。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前举例工厂排污导致下游鱼类死亡、水质恶化、社区受损；空后写海滩上的塑料被洋流带入海洋威胁海洋生物。B项“单一污染源可以损害远离其周边的大片生态系统”概括本段“污染扩散”主题，与前后一致。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前讲一国排放温室气体使全球大气升温；空后写“一地区排放导致冰川融化、海平面上升和各地极端天气，没有国家能真正孤立于气候变化影响之外”。C项“一地的污染与排放影响整个星球，需要全球行动”概括气候变化的全球性及应对要求。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前指出蝴蝶效应也可以正向作用；空后举例回收一个瓶子、种一棵树、短途步行代替开车，并强调“数百万人做出这些选择时，集体影响巨大”。D项“简单的正面行动在许多人参与时，能带来显著环境改善”准确概括本段逻辑。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前为第四段；空后写“我们做的每个选择都会在世界上产生涟漪”，并号召做有意识的环保决定。将E项“认识到我们影响改变的力量，激励我们为地球做出更好选择”置于段首，总结全文并升华主题。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, a single oil spill can kill thousands of birds and contaminate miles of coastline.**：以For example开头，为原油泄漏的具体例子。虽与环境污

染和扩散相关，但仅属[2]或[3]段的举例层次，无法承担[1]–[5]的概括或递进功能；易误选为[2]。